

SNIPPETS

BEE star rating becomes mandatory for devices

Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) has made it compulsory for IT and electronics hardware manufacturers to get their products, such as computers, laptops and set-top boxes, star-rated. The BEE will award a rating from one star to five stars based on the energy saving capacity of devices.

Agilent opens new campus

Agilent Technologies has opened a new state-of-the-art campus in Manesar, Haryana, with an investment of about Rs 17.7 billion. The campus will house 1200 out of the company's 1500 workers in India.

ZTE Telecom plans to expand

ZTE Telecom hopes to capture 10-15 per cent market share of India's \$4-billion telecom vendor market through its business from 3G and WiMax sectors. The company is working on major plans for India to grow by around 30 per cent every year in the 3G and WiMax sectors.

Panasonic sets up car electronics unit

To tap the growing local demand, Panasonic has set up Panasonic Automotive Systems, a car electronics sales company, in India. The new unit will sell car navigation systems, audio equipment as well as switches, sensors and other automobile parts.

Motorola to launch iSIM in India

Thanks to Motorola, smartphone users will soon be able to use up to four phone numbers on a single handset, without even having to buy a multi-SIM handset. Motorola is in talks with all telecom service providers in India to launch iSIM, which is a flexible wafer that can be attached to the original SIM, allowing the user to access four numbers on the same handset.

HCL on a hiring spree

After recording impressive profits in the third quarter, HCL Technologies is planning to hire 5000 people in 2010, compared with the 2000 it had hired in 2009.

Videocon to invest in telecom

Videocon Mobile Services plans to invest about Rs 150 billion for developing the necessary telecommunications infrastructure in India. The company has also set an ambitious target of 100 million customers within the next three years.

2009-10 to Rs 2000 million in 2010-11. It is also planning to foray into solar power solutions next year.

"In the coming year, we will add new products to our portfolio and expand our presence across the country," informed Uniline managing director R.K. Bansal.

Uniline plans to expand the number of channel partners across India. It will have three distributors in every state and one dealer in each city. Presently, the company has 67 channel partners across the country, who account for 37 per cent revenue of the company.

National Instruments expands R&D operations

National Instruments (NI), a leader

in graphical system design, has set up a new R&D facility at its India centre in Bengaluru. The facility is equipped with best-in-class product development infrastructure and employee workspace to provide the tools and environment required for efficient product innovation and R&D.

As part of the strategic growth, NI will hire new talent and take on more work in the areas of product development in NI's core products such as LabVIEW, RF and Vision.

Plasma TV makers eye 3-D to beat LCDs

LCD TVs accounted for as much as 70 per cent of the global TV market of

around 210 million units in 2009 and plasma display panels (PDPs) only 7 per cent. The rest of the market share was claimed by CRT TVs.

LCDs outshine PDPs because of their technological edge in producing smaller sizes. In fact, with falling prices, these have started eating up the market share of PDPs in large-size category also. However, PDP makers expect to take their market share back from LCD TVs by launching 3-D models, which usually come in big screen sizes where PDPs score over LCDs in pricing and provide wider viewing angle and quicker response.

China eBook shipments to grow 70 per cent

With the growing popularity of the Amazon Kindle and Sony Reader, Chinese manufacturers and content providers are rushing to join the domestic eBook market. eBooks are the devices for reading text on electronic displays and are expected to sell like hot cakes this year in China.

Shipments of eBooks in China will increase to 3.6 million units in 2010 from 2.1 million units in 2009, according to iSuppli Corp. By 2014, the figure will reach 17.6 million.

Sales of digital textbooks up in USA

A survey done by translation services provider Xplanation has found that sales of digital textbooks in the US will surpass 18 per cent of combined new textbook sales for the higher education and career education markets. This rise will boost the revenue sales for digital books by around \$1 billion.

The rise in sales is attributed to factors like digital textbook and e-content pricing, availability of digital textbook content, advances in related technology, increased growth of online learning, and rise in open educational resources and their use.